

account. If you already have a Google account, then you need nothing more to be set up.

Creating A Profile

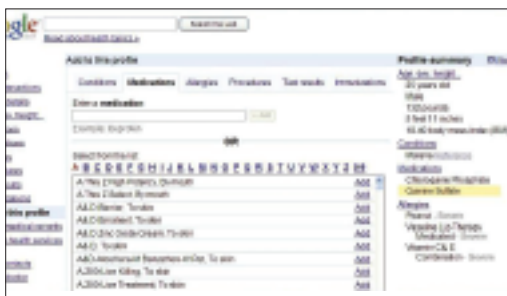
To start using Google Health service, go to www.google.com/health. Enter your Google ID and password. On the home page, you will see links for notices, drug interactions, conditions, medications, allergies, etc. Enter your details in the section for Profile details. Fill in as much data as you have, so that it helps the next doctor that you visit and gives him as much information as possible.

Conditions

Once you click on Conditions, select all the medical ailments that you suffer from. You can do so by selecting them from the list provided.

Medication

Similarly, after you enter all the conditions and allergies that you suffer from. This will help your doctor to be careful with his prescription, so you do not develop any unfavourable reactions. For example, if you have an allergy to Vaseline, he would avoid cream based preparations, and rather prefer tablets or capsules.

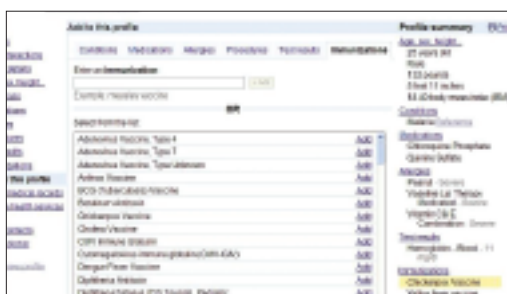


Get all the information you need on medication

Vaccinations

On the link for vaccinations, you can enter all the inoculations and vaccinations that you have undergone, so that your doctor has a history of all prophylactic treatments and courses you have undergone.

The aim of Google Health is not to treat you, but to provide you with an efficient means of storing your health records. Although currently it would not be possible to use it to its



Find out what you can be vaccinated against

full potential, in its present shape it proves to be highly effective in the US, where the site has strategic partnerships with reputed hospitals and clinics. Nevertheless, the pool of resources is still available to you. Besides, if Google decides to tie up with hospitals in a similar way in India, then that would be an added boon that's worth waiting for.

WebMD

The other site that we present to you is WebMD.com. This site from the very view of the home page appears to be one power packed with information and not for a moment does it let you down.



WebMD is a treasure trove of medical information

On this Web site, the most helpful and informative tool is the symptom checker, which approaches your ailment using a graphical interface. Once you select your gender, you get a diagram of the human body, with main sections highlighted when you hover the mouse around. Say, you have a back ache. First select the back view. Next, click on the part of your back that's giving you trouble. You will see a list of symptoms associated with the back.

On selecting ache, you will see a list of possible causes for your pain. Although this may feel mysterious, just click on any one symptom and all your doubts will vanish. You will see a tab titled overview. This tab tells you about the symptom. Similarly, View All Symptoms tells you about all associated symptoms that can be informative.

Well, we do have doctors all around us, then why look online? Certainly, doctors are the final answer to our health woes, but did all the confident support for them just fade away? We need awareness! The intention of presenting this article is to increase awareness of health issues, and to do away with myths associated with diseases. ☒

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